

Why do plants have flowers?

A plant's flowers help it to reproduce (make more plants). Flowers attract insects and some birds and bats. These animals carry a grainy dust called pollen from one flower to another. Flowers use this pollen to produce seeds.

Spreading seeds

A plant needs to spread its seeds so that new plants can grow. Many plants make seeds inside fruit. Animals eat the fruit and scatter these seeds in their droppings. Some other flowers, such as dandelions, produce very light seeds that blow away in the wind.



Sticky stigma.

Visiting insects may rub against the stigma, leaving pollen grains behind. Each grain grows a tube that travels down the style to the ovary.

Stigma

Style

Anther

Pollen store.

Anthers produce the tiny grains of pollen that stick to visiting insects.

Pretty petals.

The color, shape, and size of a flower's petals, and the smell of the flower, attract insects.

